Practice workbook · Improving a study: who and where

Suggesting a change to who or where a study samples so that findings are more representative and generalisable.

11 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 10 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-RM-11

1. Question 17 · part b · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

17 Sandy has been asked to investigate the function of 'Region G' of the brain.

She decides to give some tests to one of her female patients who has damaged 'Region G' of their brain:

- Colour naming test: The patient is asked to name what colour they see when presented with a coloured piece of paper.
- Recall test: The patient is asked to recall the months of the year in order and when they were born.
- Pressure test: Physical pressure is applied to the patient when they are blindfolded and they have to say where they can feel the pressure being applied.

The patient performed well on the recall test and pressure test but performed poorly on the colour naming test.

(a) Explain which region of the brain the patient is likely to have damaged from their performance in the tests.

You should refer to the function of the damaged region in your answer.

(2)

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(b) Explain **one** improvement Sandy could have made to her investigation.

(2)

(Total for Question 17 = 4 marks)

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1. Question 17 · part b · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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2. Question 3 · part c · 2 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

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3 Vanessa investigated age differences in driving speed. She conducted an observation by a road in the local town. Vanessa recorded the speed that young drivers and mature drivers drove their cars in miles per hour (mph).

The number of young drivers and mature drivers who were recorded driving at each speed is shown in **Table 3**.

	1mph to 10mph	11mph to 20mph	21mph to 30mph	31mph to 40mph
Young driver	1	4	9	12
Mature driver	1	5	14	18

Table 3

(a) Calculate the difference between the number of young drivers who were recorded driving at 1mph to 20mph and the number of young drivers who were recorded driving at 21mph to 30mph.

(1)

Difference .....

(b) Calculate the ratio of young drivers to mature drivers that Vanessa recorded driving at 31mph to 40mph.

(1)

Ratio .....

(c) Explain **one** improvement that Vanessa could make to her investigation.

(2)

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(Total for Question 3 = 4 marks)

2. Question 3 · part c · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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3. Question 5 · part b · 2 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

5 Leanne is investigating children's development at a local school. She asks 30 pupils, aged 6 years old, 8 years old and 10 years old, to participate in her investigation.

Leanne asks the pupils to come to the gymnasium and put on a virtual reality (VR) headset, where they will see a simulation of a set of buildings. The buildings are different shapes and colours.

- A triangular blue building.
- A square red building.
- A rectangular black building.

From the pupils' perspective, the triangular building is at the front and the rectangular building is at the back of the image. The pupils are asked to say what a person living on the opposite side of the town will see.

Table 1 shows the overall responses given by the pupils.

Pupil age	Number of pupils who said the triangular building would be at the front and the rectangular building would be at the back	Number of pupils who said the rectangular building would be at the front and the triangular building would be at the back
6 years old	26	4
8 years old	13	17
10 years old	3	27

Table 1

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3. Question 5 · part b · 2 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(a) Explain **one** conclusion you could make regarding the cognitive development of the children using the data from **Table 1**.

(2)

(b) Explain **one** improvement that Leanne could have made to her investigation.

(2)

(Total for Question 5 = 4 marks)

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3. Question 5 · part b · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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4. Question 11 · part b · 2 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

11 Lydia wants to investigate the effects of a new painkiller on memory. She wants to see if the new painkiller affects people's ability to remember new information. Lydia recruits male participants from her local town for her investigation.

Lydia has two conditions:

- No painkiller – The male participants are shown three pictures. One hour later, the participants have to pick the three pictures from a selection of nine pictures.
- Painkiller – The same male participants are given the new painkiller. The participants are shown three new pictures. One hour later, the participants have to pick the three pictures from a selection of nine pictures.

Lydia's results are shown in **Table 2**.

Condition	Average number of pictures correctly recognised (out of 3)
No painkiller	2.9
Painkiller	1.1

Table 2

(a) Explain **one** conclusion that could be made using the data in **Table 2**. **(2)**

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4. Question 11 · part b · 2 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Explain **one** improvement Lydia could make to her investigation. (2)

(Total for Question 11 = 4 marks)

Working and answer

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5. Question 18 · part b · 4 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

18 Holly is interested in how damage to the pre-frontal cortex can impact on personality.

Holly asks 10 male patients who are patients at her local hospital with pre-frontal cortex damage to talk about the differences in their personality before and after the damage.

(a) Explain what Holly is likely to find in her investigation.

You should refer to a study in your answer.

(2)

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5. Question 18 · part b · 4 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Explain **two** improvements that could be made to Holly's study.

(4)

Improvement one:

Improvement two:

(Total for Question 18 = 6 marks)

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5. Question 18 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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6. Question 15 · part b · 2 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

15 Jasper is investigating the impact mental health issues have on individuals.

He visits a number of countries and carries out structured interviews using pre-determined questions with people with mental health issues. Jasper collates the information and categorises the scores on three measures.

- Likelihood of feeling shunned: experiencing being avoided by people after diagnosis
- Likelihood of feeling isolated: experiencing being alone after diagnosis
- Likelihood of being given better treatment: experiencing benefits after diagnosis

He categorises the scores as 'High', 'Mid', or 'Low' for each of the themes.

Table 1 shows Jasper's results.

Country	Likelihood of feeling shunned	Likelihood of feeling isolated	Likelihood of being given better treatment
England	MID	MID	MID
Germany	HIGH	HIGH	LOW
Italy	HIGH	HIGH	LOW
Bulgaria	HIGH	MID	LOW
Croatia	MID	HIGH	LOW
France	HIGH	HIGH	MID
Finland	MID	MID	MID

Table 1

(a) Explain **one** conclusion that Jasper could make, using **Table 1**, regarding how mental health issues affect individuals.

(2)

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6. Question 15 · part b · 2 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Explain **one** improvement Jasper could have made to his investigation into mental health issues affecting individuals.

(2)

(Total for Question 15 = 4 marks)

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Working and answer

7. Question 19 · part b · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

19 Josh is investigating sex differences in spatial ability. He asks one female and one male to carry out a spatial ability map reading task. The participants have to independently navigate their way from a castle to a cake shop using the quickest route possible using a map.

(a) Explain **one** likely outcome of the map reading task.

You should refer to research evidence regarding sex differences in your answer.

(2)

(b) Explain **one** improvement that could have been made to Josh's investigation.

(2)

(Total for Question 19 = 4 marks)

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7. Question 19 · part b · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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8. Question 13 · part b · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

13 Mary wanted to see the influence of life events on depression. Mary recruited participants from a local business who had experienced or were currently experiencing depression.

Mary gave the participants a closed-ended questionnaire which asked them about the type and number of stressful life events they had experienced in the past five years. She also asked them about the length of time (in months) they had experienced depressive symptoms and the severity of their depression, on a scale of 0–32, where 32 indicated extremely severe symptoms.

Mary's results are shown in **Table 2**.

Stressful life events (past five years)	Average length of depressive symptoms (in months)	Average severity of depressive symptoms (0–32)
0–5	6.3	12.5
6–10	12.4	13.2
11–15	15.3	12.7
16+	25.6	12.9

Table 2

(a) Explain **one** conclusion that could be made from the data in **Table 2**.

(2)

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8. Question 13 · part b · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Explain **one** improvement that could be made to Mary's investigation.

(2)

(Total for Question 13 = 4 marks)

Working and answer

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9. Question 15 · part b · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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15 (a) State **two** conclusions from Sperry (1968).

(2)

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2 .....

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(b) Explain **one** improvement that Sperry (1968) could have made to his investigation.

(2)

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(Total for Question 15 = 4 marks)

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Working and answer

10. Question 23 · part b · 2 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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23 Michael wanted to see the influence of authority on the levels of obedience of males and females.

He approached 13 male and 6 female participants when wearing a high visibility jacket and asked for their seat on a busy bus. Michael recorded the behaviour of the participants in response to the request.

Michael's results are shown in **Figure 3**.

A comparative bar chart to show the number of male and female reactions to the request to give up their seat

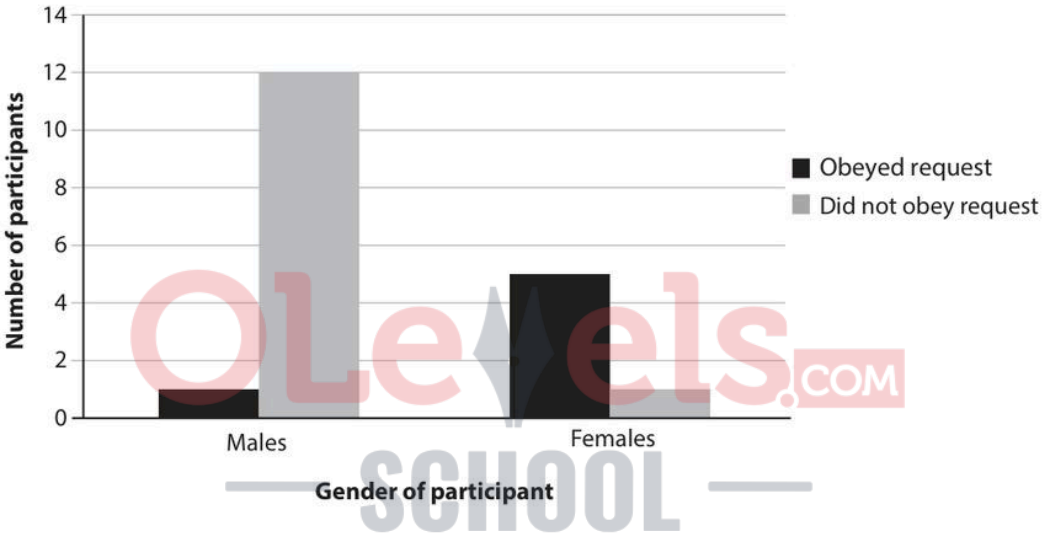


Figure 3

(a) Explain **one** conclusion that Michael could make from the data in **Figure 3**.

(2)

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10. Question 23 · part b · 2 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

(b) Explain **one** improvement that Michael could make to his study.

(2)

(Total for Question 23 = 4 marks)

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Working and answer

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11. Question 13 · part b · 2 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

13 Siobhan manages a mental health ward and is considering staffing costs for the future. Siobhan has considered the incidence of mental health problems in her ward over the past five years.

Table 2 shows the number of patients admitted to the mental health ward and the staffing costs over the last five years.

Year	Number of patients admitted to the mental health ward	Staffing costs (£)
5 years ago	26	£520,000
4 years ago	30	£600,000
3 years ago	32	£640,000
2 years ago	34	£680,000
1 year ago	35	£700,000
Current year	37	£740,000

Table 2

(a) Explain **one** conclusion that could be made from the data in **Table 2** in terms of staffing costs for Siobhan over the next five years.

(2)

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11. Question 13 · part b · 2 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Explain **one** improvement that Siobhan could make to her investigation into the future staffing costs for her mental health ward.

(2)

(Total for Question 13 = 4 marks)

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Working and answer